

D

DABOECIA

ERICACEAE

Genus of two species of evergreen shrubs in the heather family (see also p.166). Elliptical leaves are dark green above, silver-gray beneath. The flowers are urn-shaped, usually pendent, borne in erect racemes. Grow in full sun, in lime-free soil. Propagate named cultivars by cuttings or layering.

D. azorica (Queiró, Azores heath). Compact shrub. H to 6in (15cm), S to 2ft (60cm). Flowers, borne in late spring and early summer in short racemes, are vivid red, pink or white. Z6–8. **‘Arthur P. Dome’**, H 4–6in (10–15cm), S 12–18in (30–45cm), is slow-growing and prostrate, with ruby flowers.

D. cantabrica (St. Dabeoc’s heath). Straggling shrub. H to 18in (45cm), S 2ft (60cm). Top growth may be damaged by frost and cold winds, but plants respond well to hard pruning and produce new growth from base. Leaves are lance-shaped to ovate. Bears purple, mauve pink or white flowers from late spring to midfall. Z6–8. **‘Bicolor’** (illus. p.166) bears white, purple and striped flowers on the same plant. **f. blumii ‘White Blum’** bears upward-pointing, white flowers.

‘Charles Nelson’ is a sprawling shrub, with barrel-shaped, double, mauve flowers from early summer to midfall; the old corollas are not deciduous but remain on the plants. **‘Hookstone Purple’**, S to 34in (85cm), is a robust, spreading shrub, bearing large, amethyst-purple flowers from late spring to late fall.

‘Praegerae’, H 14in (35cm), has glowing deep pink flowers. **‘Romantic Muxoll’**, H 1ft (30cm), S 16in (40cm), is compact, with erect, double, rose-pink flowers; the old corollas are deciduous. **subsp. scotica** see *D. x scotica*. **‘Snowdrift’** has bright green foliage and long racemes of large, white flowers. **‘Waley’s Red’** is a spreading shrub, with glowing magenta flowers in summer.

D. x scotica, syn. *D. cantabrica* subsp. *scotica*. Compact shrub. H to 6in (15cm), S to 2ft (60cm). Bears white, purple or red flowers from late spring to midfall. Z6–8. **‘Jack Drake’**, H 8in (20cm), has small leaves and ruby-colored flowers. **‘Katherine’s Choice’**, H 8in (20cm), has mid-green foliage and bears cerise flowers in summer. **‘Silverwells’** has small, bright green leaves and large, white flowers. **‘William Buchanan’**, H 18in (45cm), is a vigorous cultivar with dark green leaves and deep purple flowers.

DACTYLORHIZA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.

D. elata, syn. *Orchis elata*. Deciduous, terrestrial orchid. H 3½ft (1.1m). Spikes of pink or purple flowers, ½–¾in (1–2cm) long, open in spring–summer. Lance-shaped leaves, 6–10in (15–25cm) long,

are spotted with brownish-purple and arranged spirally on stem. Requires shade outdoors; keep potted plants semishaded in summer. Z6–8

D. foliosa, syn. *D. maderensis*, *Orchis maderensis*, illus. p.265.

D. maderensis. See *D. foliosa*.

DAHLIA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of bushy, summer- and fall-flowering, tuberous perennials, grown as bedding plants or for their flower heads, which are good for cutting or exhibition. Dwarf forms are used for mass-planting and are also suitable for containers. Needs a sunny position and well-drained soil. All apart from dwarf forms require staking. After flowering, lift tubers and store in a frost-free place; replant once all frost danger has passed. In frost-free areas, plants may be left in ground as normal herbaceous perennials, but they benefit from regular propagation to maintain vigour. Propagate dwarf forms by seed sown under glass in late winter, others in spring by seed, basal shoot cuttings or division of tubers. Dahlias may be subject to attack by aphids, red spider mite and thrips. In recent years, powdery mildew has become a problem in certain areas, and spraying is essential. Dahlias also succumb quickly to virus infection. See also feature panel pp.396–98.

Border dahlias

Prolific and long-flowering, various species of *Dahlia* have been hybridized and, with constant breeding and selection, have developed into many forms displaying a wide color range (although there is no blue). Shoots may be stopped, or pinched out, to promote vigorous growth and a bushy shape. Spread measurements depend on the amount of stopping carried out and the time at which it is done: early stopping encourages a broader shape, stopping later in the growing season results in a taller plant with much less spread, even in the same cultivar. Leaves are generally mid-green and divided into ovate leaflets, some with rounded tips and some with toothed margins. Each flower head is referred to horticulturally as a flower, even though it does in fact comprise a large number of individual flowers. This horticultural usage has been followed in the descriptions below. All forms with flower heads to 6in (15cm) across are suitable for cutting; those suitable for exhibition are so noted.

Groups and flower sizes

Dahlias are divided into groups according to the size and type of their flower heads, although the latter may vary in color and shape depending on soil and weather conditions. The groups are: (1) Single-flowered; (2) Anemone-flowered; (3) Collerette; (4) Waterlily; (5) Decorative; (6) Ball; (7) Pompom; (8) Cactus; (9) Semicactus; (10) Miscellaneous; (11) Fimbriated; (12) Single orchid (Star); (13) Double orchid and Stellar; (14) Peony-flowered. For illustrations and descriptions see p.396.

The term Dwarf bedder can apply to any form of dahlia to 2ft (60cm) high. Lilliput dahlias are even smaller, to 1ft (30cm) high. The flowers may have single, semi-double or double flowers up to 1in (25cm) in diameter. For exhibition purposes certain groups may be subdivided; flower sizes are as follows:

Groups 4, 5, 8, 9, 11

A—giant-flowered; usually over 10in (25cm) in diameter. B—large-flowered; usually 8–10in (20–25cm) in diameter. C—medium-flowered; usually 6–8in (15–20cm) in diameter. D—small-flowered; usually 4–6in (10–15cm) in diameter. E—miniature-flowered; usually not exceeding 4in (10cm) in diameter.

Group 6

A—small ball dahlias; usually 4–6in (10–15cm) in diameter. B—miniature ball dahlias; usually 2–4in (5–10cm) in diameter.

Group 7

Pompom dahlias; not exceeding 2in (5cm) in diameter.

D. ‘Akita’ (illus. p.398). Miscellaneous dahlia. H 4ft (1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Produces dark crimson to red flowers, to 5in (13cm) across, with yellow centers, in summer–fall. The reverses of the petals are tipped white. Z9–11

D. ‘Almand’s Climax’. Decorative dahlia. H 3½ft (1.1m), S 2ft (60cm). In summer–fall, bears pinkish-purple blooms streaked with white. Good for both exhibition and garden display. Z9–11

D. ‘Alva’s Doris’. Small-flowered Cactus dahlia. H 4ft (1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Free-flowering with blood-red blooms on strong stems in summer–fall. Good for exhibition. Z9–11

D. ‘Alva’s Supreme’ (illus. p.398). Giant-flowered Decorative dahlia. H 4ft (1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Produces yellow flowers in summer–fall. Good for exhibition. Z9–11

D. ‘Ann Breckenfelder’. Collerette dahlia. H 3½ft (1.1m), S 2ft (60cm). In summer–fall, bears bright orange-red blooms with an inner collar of greenish-yellow florets. Good for both exhibition and garden display. Z9–11

D. ‘Anniversary Ball’, syn. *D. ‘Brookfield Enid’*. Miniature Ball dahlia. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Produces lilac and pink flowers in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Appetiser’. Small-flowered Semicactus dahlia. H 4ft (1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Produces yellow and pink flowers in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Arabian Night’ (illus. p.397). Small-flowered Decorative dahlia. H 4ft (1.2m), S 1½ft (50cm). Has dark green leaves. Double, dark burgundy-red flowers are borne in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Autumn Fairy’. Miniature-flowered, Semicactus dahlia. H 16in (40cm), S 1ft (30cm). Soft orange flowers, with darker centers, are borne in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Barry Williams’. Medium-flowered Decorative dahlia. H 4ft (1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Bears pink and yellow flowers in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Bednall Beauty’. Peony-flowered dahlia. H 4½ft (1.3m), S 2ft (60cm). Bears vivid red blooms in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Berwick Wood’ (illus. p.397). Medium-flowered Decorative dahlia. H 4½ft (1.3m), S 2ft (60cm). In summer–fall, produces dark-centered, purple flowers on strong stems. Z9–11

D. ‘Bishop of Auckland’ (illus. p.397). Single-flowered dahlia. H 32in (80cm), S 18in (45cm). Bears matte blackish-green leaves and single, open-centered, dusky-red flowers in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Bishop of Llandaff’ (illus. p.398). Peony-flowered dahlia. H 3ft (1m), S 1½ft (45cm). Has bronze-green leaves and single, open-centered, dark red flowers, 3in (8cm) across, in summer–fall. Excellent as a bedding plant. Z9–11

D. ‘Bishop of York’ (illus. p.398). Single-flowered dahlia. H 32in (80cm), S 18in (45cm). Produces dark purple leaves and single, open-centered, orange-blushed, golden flowers in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Black Narcissus’ (illus. p.398). Medium-flowered Semicactus dahlia. H 5ft (1.5m), S 2ft (60cm). Bears intensely dark red blooms in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Blyton Softer Gleam’. Ball dahlia. H 4½ft (1.3m), S 2ft (60cm). Bears yellow blooms with soft orange tips in summer–fall. Good for both exhibition and garden display. Z9–11

D. ‘Brian’s Dream’ (illus. p.397). Miniature-flowered Decorative dahlia. H 3–4ft (1–1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Produces creamy-white flowers, with petal tips suffused purplish-pink, in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Brookfield Enid’. See *D. ‘Anniversary Ball’*.

D. ‘Butterball’. Miniature-flowered decorative dahlia. H 2ft (60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Produces bright yellow flowers in early summer. Z9–11

D. ‘Café au Lait’ (illus. p.396). Giant-flowered Decorative dahlia. H 3ft (90cm), S 2ft (60cm). Cream flowers that merge into pale peach in the centers are borne in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Cameo’. Small-flowered Waterlily dahlia. H 30in (75cm), S 18in (45cm). Cream flowers with a yellow base are borne in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Candy Cupid’. Miniature Ball dahlia. H 3½ft (1.1m), S 2ft (60cm). In summer–fall, bears lavender-pink flowers that are good for exhibition. Z9–11

D. ‘Carolina Moon’ (illus. p.397). Small-flowered Waterlily dahlia. H 4ft (1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Lilac-edged, white flowers are produced in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Charlie Dimmock’ (illus. p.398). Small-flowered Waterlily dahlia. H 5½ft (1.6m), S 2ft (60cm). Bears apricot flowers on a pale yellow ground, in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Chat Noir’. Medium-flowered Semicactus dahlia. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Produces deep reddish-black flowers in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Cherokee Beauty’. Giant-flowered Decorative dahlia. H 4½ft (1.3m), S 2–3ft (60–90cm). Bears pink flowers in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Cherwell Skylark’. Small-flowered Semicactus dahlia. H 3ft (1m), S 20–24in (50–60cm). Bears orange-flushed, salmon-pink blooms in summer–fall. Z9–11

D. ‘Chimborazo’ (illus. p.398). Collerette dahlia. H 3½ft (1.1m), S 2ft (60cm). Leaves are glossy, dark green. Very free-